

EXCLUSIVE

IAS PRELIMS 2026

CURRENT AFFAIRS

REVISION

GS-1 (DYNAMIC)

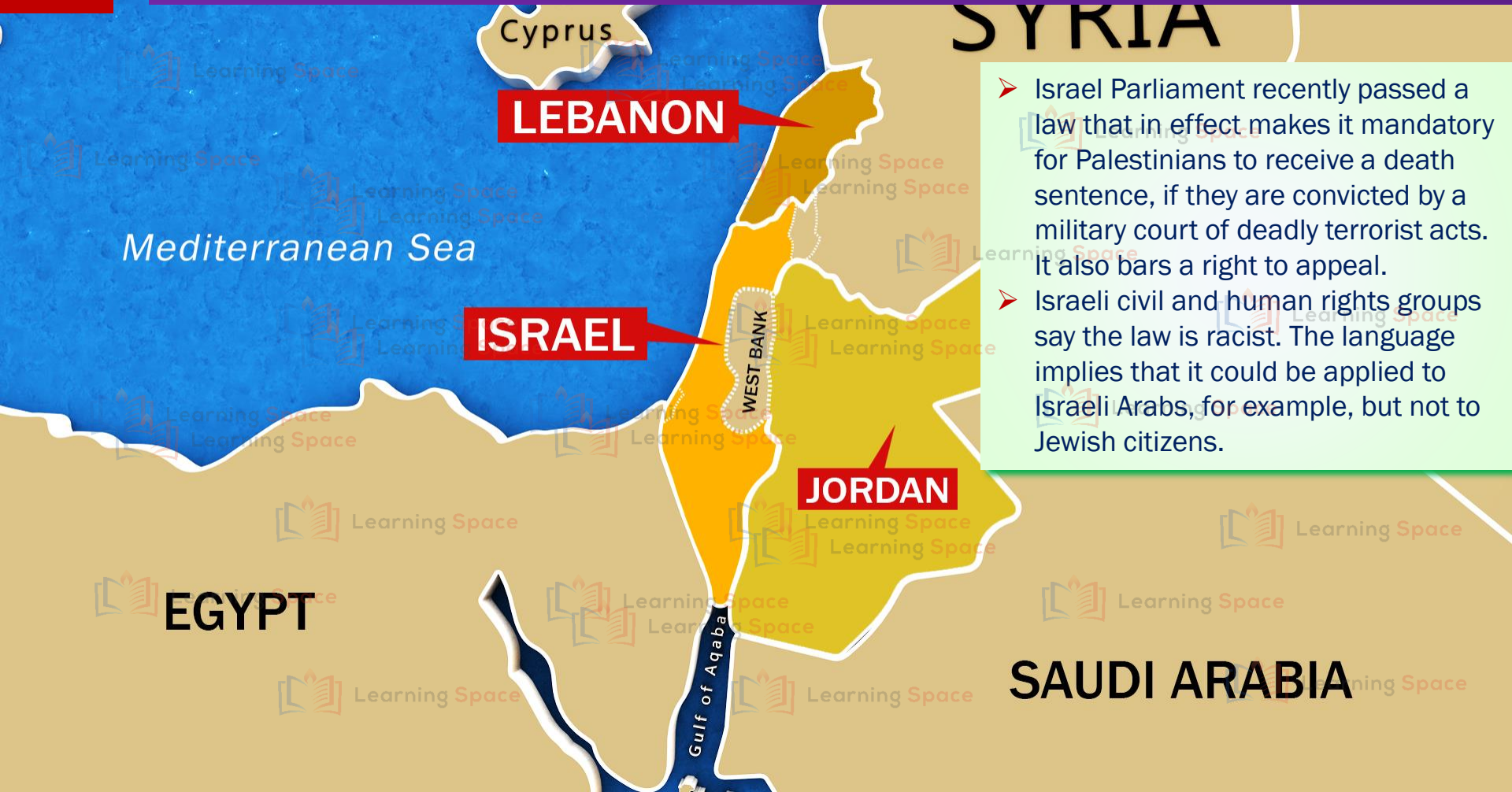
MODULE - 68



**MISCELLANEOUS
EVENTS - 9**



- Israel announced that it would establish a security zone in Southern Lebanon policed by Israeli troops in order to curtail Hezbollah's activities.
- Soldiers blew up bridges crossing the Litani River around 20 km north of the Israeli border to secure the area.
- Hezbollah, which is backed by Iran, agreed on paper to a ceasefire in 2024, but launched missiles at Israel again recently,



- Israel Parliament recently passed a law that in effect makes it mandatory for Palestinians to receive a death sentence, if they are convicted by a military court of deadly terrorist acts. It also bars a right to appeal.
- Israeli civil and human rights groups say the law is racist. The language implies that it could be applied to Israeli Arabs, for example, but not to Jewish citizens.



- K.P. Sharma Oli, Nepal's former Prime Minister, was arrested in connection with the crackdown on last year's protests in which 77 people died. Mr. Oli resigned, and a subsequent election was won by Balendra Shah, a former rapper and one of the leaders of the Gen Z movement behind the protests.
- A former government minister was also arrested after a commission recommended that both men be charged with criminal negligence.



- The Thai-Cambodian crisis has colonial roots in the Franco-Siamese (Thai treaties of 1904 and 1907), which defined the boundary between Siam and French-Indochina. While these treaties stretched borders along the forested Dangrek ranges, the line remained largely undemarcated on the ground.
- The flashpoint has been Preah Vihear, the 11th century Khmer Hindu temple and UNESCO World Heritage Site.
- In 1962, the International Court of Justice awarded Cambodia sovereignty over the temple, but the dispute has endured in the absence of a mutually accepted border demarcation.



- The crisis in Congo can be traced back to the 1994 Rwandan genocide in which about 8 lakh people, mostly Tutsis, were massacred by ethnic Hutu militias. After the genocidal regime in Kigali fell, thousands of Hutus fled to Congo in the mid-1990s.
- Rwanda now claims that some of the militias that took part in the genocide continue to operate from Congolese territory.
- M23, which takes its name from a failed peace agreement signed between a Tutsi-led rebel group and the Congolese Government on March 23, 2009, says it is fighting to protect the rights of Congo's Tutsi ethnic minority.
- The Congo and UN experts say neighboring Rwanda, ruled by a Tutsi-led government, is backing M23.

Recently, on December 4, Donald Trump hosted the leaders of Rwanda and the DRC in Washington for the signing of a formal peace agreement. As per analysts, Mr. Trump's declaration that he brought the war to end appears premature, given the complexity of the crisis.



- The Fur tribe once ruled the Islamic Sultanate of Darfur until the killing in 1916 of the last Sultan of Darfur.
- Darfur region has seen a protracted conflict since 2003. The conflict stems from long-standing land and water disputes between semi-nomadic Arab pastoralists and non-Arab farming communities.
- The main groups involved were the Sudanese Government and Government-backed Arab militias, known as Janjaweed on one side, and non-Arab rebel groups on the other side. The conflict is considered one of the world's worst humanitarian crises involving mass killings, displacement of millions, widespread violence and famine.
- The current Sudanese Civil War (since April 2023 between the Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF) and the Rapid Support Forces (RSF), which evolved from the Janjaweed militia) has reignited the crisis in Darfur with renewed ethnic violence and a catastrophic hunger crisis.

Rape, mass killings carried out by the RSF in El Fasher in Darfur region were shocking. It was born from the Arab supremacist Janjaweed militia in the early 2000s.



- The US Department of State has designated Cartel de los Soles (Cartel of the Suns) as a foreign terrorist organization, effective November 24, 2025. According to the USA, the Venezuela-based cartel is headed by President Nicolas Maduro and other high-ranking officials of the government, corrupting the country's military, intelligence, legislature, and judiciary.
- The term Cartel de los Soles emerged in the 1990s, coined by Venezuelan media after a general overseeing counter-narcotic action in the National Guard was accused of drug trafficking.
- The name stems from the sun insignia worn by Venezuelan military officers on the epaulettes of their uniform to indicate rank. Soon, the term spread to all officials with alleged drug ties not necessarily belonging to one organization.

As per USA, the cartel is “a series of normally disconnected cells embedded within the Venezuelan military”, rather than a traditional hierarchical crime organization.



- G77 is the largest intergovernmental block of developing nations at the UN, currently with around 134 member countries. It is focused on promoting collective economic interests and negotiating power.
- China participates as a special case partner, often referred to as G77 and China.
- G77 was formed at the first UN Conference on Trade and Development UNCTAD in 1964. This group articulates shared economic interests, enhances joint negotiating capacity within the UN system and addresses developmental challenges.

What do you know about the recent escalation of tensions between China and Japan?

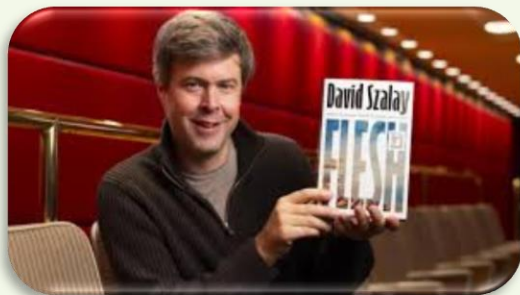


- Japanese Prime Minister sparked a controversy when she said that a Chinese assault on Taiwan could be deemed a survival-threatening situation - a legal justification allowing Tokyo to exercise collective self-defense. China claims sovereignty over Taiwan, a position Taipei firmly rejects.
- Japan's post-war constitution forbids it from using force as a means of setting international disputes. But a 2015 law passed, when Shinzo Abe was the Prime Minister, permits it to exercise collective self-defense in certain situations, even if it is not directly under attack.
- China is Japan's largest trade partner. China accounted for 20% of Japan's exports and imports each between 2018 and 2024.

Annually, over \$440 billion trade passes through Taiwan Strait, the highest for any country, followed by South Korea. Japan feels that Chinese military actions against Taiwan could pose a threat to Japan's survival, implying that Tokyo might intervene militarily.



- Pakistani President on November 13, 2025, signed the 27th Amendment to the 1973 constitution into law. This was previously passed by Senate and the National Assembly.
- It will establish the Chief of Defense Forces Office, which will always be held by the Army Chief, who will effectively also command the Pakistani Navy and Air Force.
- It gives complete legal immunity to five-star rank officers even after demitting office. Five-star officers will remain in uniform for life and can be removed only through an impeachment like process under Article 47.
- There is a supersession of the Supreme Court of Pakistan (SCP), through a new federal institutional court, which asserts the SCP's power to hear constitutional matters.



- The 2025 Booker Prize is a literary award worth 50,000 pound given for the best English language novel published between 1 October 2024 and 30th September 2025 in either the United Kingdom or Ireland. “FLESH” by David Szalay won the prize. He is the first Hungarian-British author to win the Booker Prize. He is the author of six works of fiction that have been translated into over 20 languages.
- Booker Prize is conferred each year for the best single work of sustained fiction written in the English language, which was published in the UK or Ireland. The winner receives 50,000 pounds as well as international publicity that usually leads to a significant sales boost.
- It was presented by Man Group till 2019 and from 2019 onwards by Crankstart.

International Booker Prize is awarded for a work of fiction translated into English and published in the UK or Ireland.

Unlike the Booker Prize, short story collections are also eligible for the International Booker Prize. Moreover, 50,000 pounds is split between author and translator.

This slide gives an idea about the extent of summer crops (Zaid Crops)

Zaid crop coverage drops 2% as paddy acreage trails

Slip in area

	2025*	2026*	(lakh hectare) % Change
Paddy	28.65	27.86	-2.8
Pulses	3.47	4.09	17.9
Moong	2.18	2.57	17.9
Urad	1.14	1.28	12.3
Nutri/Coarse Cereals	6.84	6.04	-11.7
Bajra	1.35	1.38	2.2
Maize	5	4.24	-15.2
Oilseeds	4.73	4.69	-0.8
Groundnut	2.97	2.98	0.3
Sesamum	1.42	1.35	-4.9
All crops	43.69	42.68	-2.3

*As of March 20

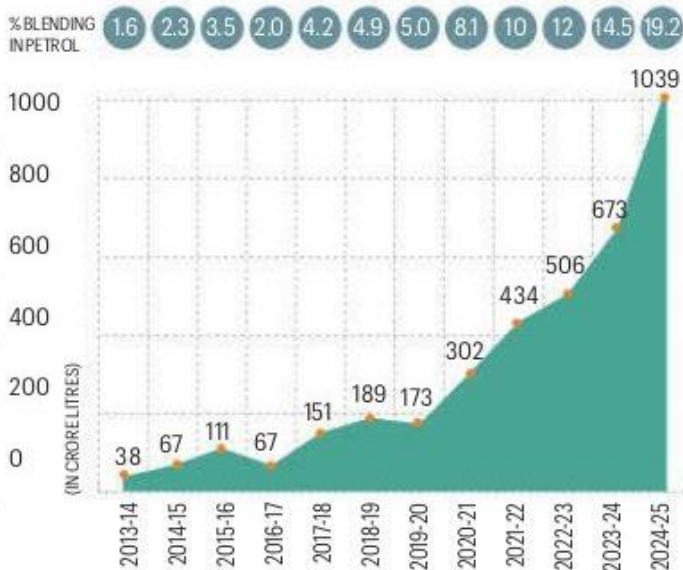
This is the comparison between CAFE-2 and Draft CAFÉ-3 norms

Clean transition

Parameter	CAFE-2 norms	Draft CAFE-3 norms
Implementation period	FY23 to FY27	FY28 to FY32
Fuel consumption targets 	Set progressive CO ₂ reduction targets based on vehicle weights	Introduces tighter fuel consumption limits with revised annual constants
Compliance flexibility 	Limited flexibility for compliance, with no defined rule in place	Expands flexibility through credit trading, manufacturer pooling and credit purchases
Incentive for low-carbon technologies 	Provided super credits for EVs and hybrids, and limited CO ₂ -reducing technologies allowed	Adds incentives like carbon neutrality factor for ethanol, CNG and hybrids, more tech credits and higher super credit multipliers for EVs, plug-in hybrids

This is a snapshot on Ethanol supply to OMCs and Ethanol supply by feedstock

• Ethanol supply to oil marketing companies



• Ethanol supply by feedstock (in crore litres)

Supply Year	C-Heavy Molasses	B-Heavy Molasses	Cane Juice	Maize	Surplus FCIRice	Damaged Foodgrain
2013-14	38	0	0	0	0	0
2014-15	67	0	0	0	0	0
2015-16	111	0	0	0	0	0
2016-17	67	0	0	0	0	0
2017-18	151	0	0	0	0	0
2018-19	146	33	1	0	0	10
2019-20	74	68	15	0	0	16
2020-21	39	183	39	0	2	39
2021-22	11	265	85	0	49	24
2022-23	6	235	128	32	74	32
2023-24	58	149	64	286	0	116
2024-25	17	139	165	498	140	80
2025-26*	14	113	165	479	233	54

*CONTRACTED QUANTITY TILL NOW. SUPPLY YEARS ARE DEC-NOV TILL 2021-22; DEC-OCT FOR 2022-23 AND NOV-OCT FROM 2023-24.

As the patent on Wegovy and Ozempic expires, GLP-1 drugs may flood Indian market

• The price war

Natco Pharma	2 mg/1.5ml	4 mg/3 ml	8 mg/3 ml		
Cost of vial	Rs 1,290	Rs 1,290	Rs 1,750		
Cost of pen device	Rs 4,000	Rs 4,200	Rs 4,500		
Eris Lifesciences	2mg/1.5 ml	4 mg/3 ml	8 mg/3 ml		
Cost of vial	Rs 1,290	Rs 1,290	N.A.		
Cost of pen device	Rs 4,000	Rs 4,200	Rs 4,500		
Novo Nordisk	0.25mg/1.5ml	0.5mg/1.5ml	1mg/3ml	1.7mg/3ml	2.4mg/3ml
Cost of Wegovy pen device	Rs 10,850	Rs 13,850	Rs 13,850	Rs 16,400	Rs 16,400
Emcure Pharma*	0.25mg/1.5ml	0.5mg/1.5ml	1mg/3ml	1.7mg/3ml	2.4mg/3ml
Cost of Poviztra pen device	Rs 8,790	Rs 11,200	Rs 11,200	Rs 13,000	Rs 15,000

PRICES FOR A MONTH OF TREATMENT, *LAUNCHED IN DEC 2025 IN TIE-UP WITH NOVO, SOURCE: PHARMARACK, COMPANIES

Mobile exports touched Rs. 2 lakh crore in FY25.

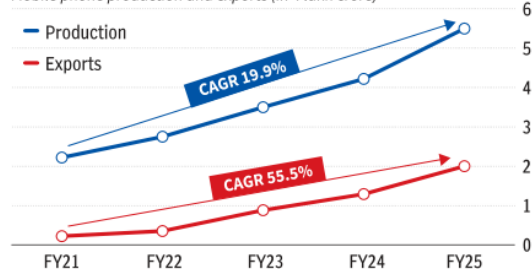
Smartphones is the largest component of electronic exports.

Smartphones is the biggest export category by value

Ringing in growth

Mobile exports grow nearly nine-fold since FY21, reaching ₹2 lakh crore in FY25

Mobile phone production and exports (in ₹ lakh crore)



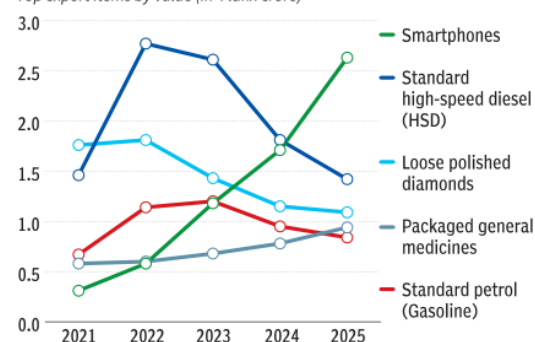
Smartphones, the largest component of electronic exports

Top 5 electronic goods export items by value (in ₹ crore)

	Smartphones	Computers & Laptops	High-Frequency Electronic Equipment	Microchips & Processor Chips	Rechargeable Batteries
2021	30,848.7	165.6	33.0	1,216.7	89.8
2022	57,790.7	332.1	38.3	1,844.2	599.6
2023	1,17,914.6	1,154.4	35.9	1,006.3	1,141.0
2024	1,71,157.2	2,163.5	50.8	1,382.6	779.0
2025	2,62,452.0	4,549.0	67.0	1,297.3	520.0
CAGR	53.45%	94.00%	15.18%	1.29%	42.08%

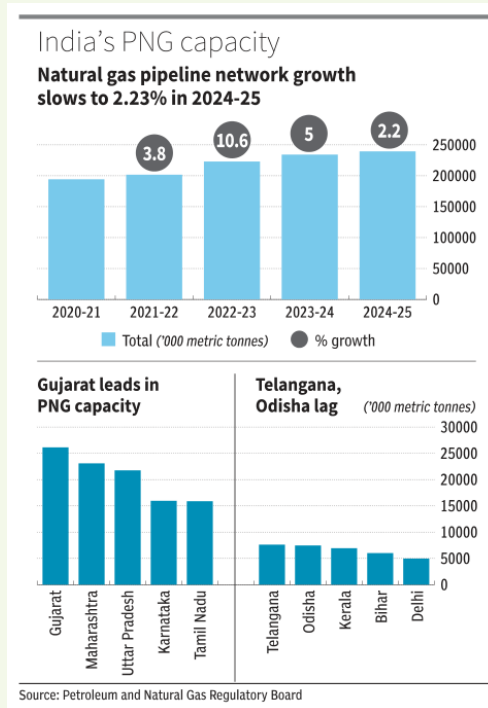
Smartphones also the biggest export category by value

Top export items by value (in ₹ lakh crore)



Source: PIB, Ministry of Commerce and Industry

In PNG capacity, Gujarat, Maharashtra and Uttar Pradesh lead the nation.



Finally, the transactions at the gift city are on increase.

Aviation asset leasing surges in volume and value at GIFT City

Type of asset	as on Dec 31, 2024	as on Dec 31, 2025
Aircraft	63	196
Engines	53	89
Aircraft auxiliary power units	80	85
Total aviation assets leased	196	370
Total aircraft lessors	30	34

- Value of aircraft leased – \$6.886 billion
- Aircraft financing – \$3.712 billion
- Aircraft financing received from international banking units – \$615 million

This slide gives an idea about traffic handled at major ports

Traffic handled at major ports (in '000 tonnes)

	April to Dec traffic 2025*	2024	% variation against prev. year traffic
Kolkata			
Kolkata Dock System	13,332	11,334	17.63
Haldia Dock Complex	37,645	32,923	14.34
Total: Kolkata	50,977	44,257	15.18
Paradip	1,15,259	1,09,517	5.24
Visakhapatnam	66,283	60,476	9.60
Kamarajar (Ennore)	36,277	35,332	2.67
Chennai	43,532	40,502	7.48
V.O. Chidambaranar	31,971	30,621	4.41
Cochin	28,427	27,692	2.65
New Mangalore	36,785	32,346	13.72
Mormugao	15,548	12,643	22.98
Mumbai	56,251	51,395	9.45
JNPA	75,429	68,373	10.32
Deendayal	1,16,247	1,08,724	6.92
Total	6,72,986	6,21,878	8.22

Main non-energy use byproducts of oil and gas exported from the Gulf countries.

TABLE 2

Key by-products

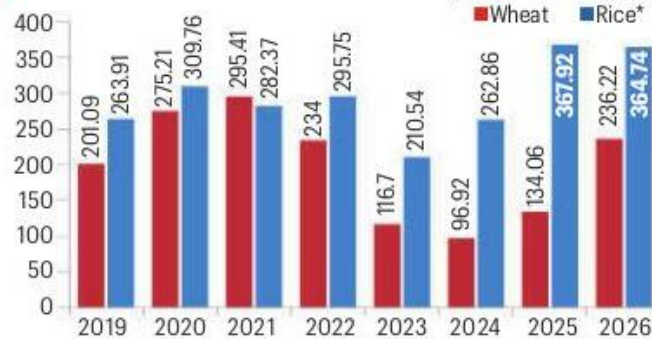
Main non-energy use by-products of oil and gas exported from the Gulf countries

Commodity	Gulf share of world production or exports (%)	Main regional exporters	Main uses
Urea	35-45 (exports)	Bahrain, Iran, Kuwait, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, UAE	Fertilizers and basic chemical input
Ammonia	30 (exports)	Bahrain, Iran, Kuwait, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, UAE	Fertilizers and basic chemical input
Helium	38.8 (production)	Qatar	Chips, medical imaging, etc.
Sulphur	21.6 (production 45 (exports)	Iran, Iraq, Kuwait, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, UAE	Fertilizer, mining and metal processing, uranium extraction
Methanol	32-35 (exports)	Bahrain, Iran, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia	Fuel, basic chemical input, biodiesel
Polyethylene	15 (capacity)	Iran, Kuwait, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, UAE	Packaging, pipes, bottles, electrical installation
Polypropylene	9 (capacity)	Iran, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, UAE	Packaging, automotives, consumer goods

Source: Centre on Global Energy Policy, quoted in <https://www.phenomenalworld.org/analysis/war-on-iran/>

Wheat and rice government stocks are quite comfortable.

• **Government stocks on March 1** (in lakh tonnes)



*DOES NOT INCLUDE UN-MILLED PADDY WITH FOOD CORPORATION OF INDIA AND STATE AGENCIES. SOURCE: DEPARTMENT OF FOOD AND PUBLIC DISTRIBUTION.

This is the balance sheet of sugar during the past five years.

• **India's sugar balance sheet** (in lakh tonnes)

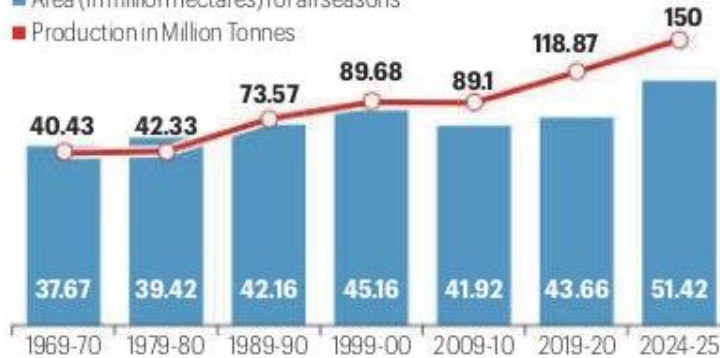
	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25	2025-26
1 Opening Stock	83.98	71.23	57.23	80.23	50.03
2 Gross Production	393.25	376.00	343.00	296.80	314.00
3 Diversion to Ethanol	34.00	45.00	24.00	35.00	31.00
4 Net Production (2-3)	359.25	331.00	319.00	261.80	283.00
5 Availability (1+4)	443.23	402.23	376.23	342.03	333.03
6 Consumption	262.00	281.00	295.00	284.00	285.00
7 Exports	110.00	64.00	1.00	8.00	7.00
8 Closing Stock (5-6-7)	71.23	57.23	80.23	50.03	41.03

NOTE: DATA IS FOR SUGAR YEAR (OCT-SEP); 2025-26 NUMBERS ARE INDUSTRY PROJECTIONS.

In 2024-25, the area under rice cultivation crossed 50 million Hectares and production 150 millions tons.

• RICE PRODUCTION: THE RISE AND RISE

- Area (in million hectares) for all seasons
- Production in Million Tonnes



SOURCE: UPAG PORTAL OF THE MINISTRY OF AGRICULTURE AND FARMERS' WELFARE

India's supply of feed raw material for livestock



ze, wheat, and other cereals are sources of carbs for livestock.

• INDIA'S SUPPLY OF FEED RAW MATERIAL

	(mntonnes)
Maize/Corn	21.0-21.5
Wheat	5.2-5.8
Other Coarse Grains	1.7-1.8
Broken Rice/DORB	7.0-8.0
Wheat Bran	6.5-7.0
Soyabean Meal	6.0-6.2
Rapeseed Meal	4.2-4.4
Cottonseed Meal	3.8-4.0
Groundnut Meal	1.4-1.5
Other Oil Meals	0.5-0.8
DDGS	3.0-3.2
TOTAL	61.0-64.0

NOTE: ESTIMATES ARE FOR 2024-25 MARKETING YEAR; DORB IS DE-OILED RICE BRAN; DDGS IS DISTILLER'S DRIED GRAINS WITH SOLUBLES. SOURCE: US DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE.

Three Padma award categories in detail

Padma award categories



Padma Vibhushan

Individuals who have rendered exceptional and distinguished service of the highest order in any field involving public service



Padma Bhushan

Individuals with distinguished service of a high order across recognised fields of work



Padma Shri

Individuals recognised for distinguished service and notable contributions at the grassroots or national level in any field

*A maximum of 120 Padma awards can be given each year, excluding posthumous awards and those given to NRIs, foreigners, and OCIs

Padma awards trivia

Year with most
Padma awards

2025 (139)

Year with least
Padma awards

1956 (25)

Person with most
Padma awards



Satyajit Ray

*Youngest
winner*

**Padma
Vibhushan**



**Sonal Mansingh
(59)**

*Oldest
winner*



**Kumudini Lakhia
(94)**

**Padma
Bhushan**



**Sonal Mansingh
(48)**



**Fathima Beevi
(96)**

**Padma
Shri**



**Sania Mirza
(19)**



**Swami Sivananda
(125)**

Total
number
of
Padma
awards

Padma
Vibhushan
343

Padma
Bhushan
1,339

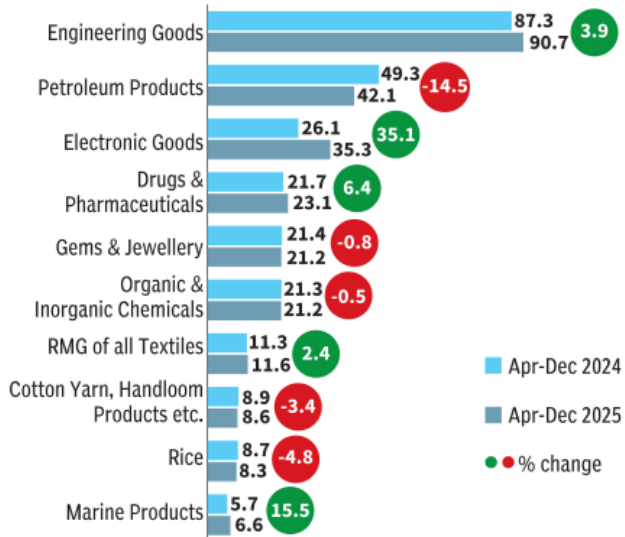
Padma
Shri
3,644

- The Padma awards began as three classes within a single honour — Pahela, Dusra, and Tisra Varg — before being renamed Padma Vibhushan, Bhushan, and Shri in 1955
- Padma awards were not awarded for seven years between 1978-79 and 1993-97
- Self-nomination is allowed for Padma awards, unlike most national honours
- A Padma awardee can wear a miniature replica of the medallion at official ceremonies, even though the award carries no monetary benefit

This is a snapshot on top 10 export commodities of India

Electronic goods lead the charge

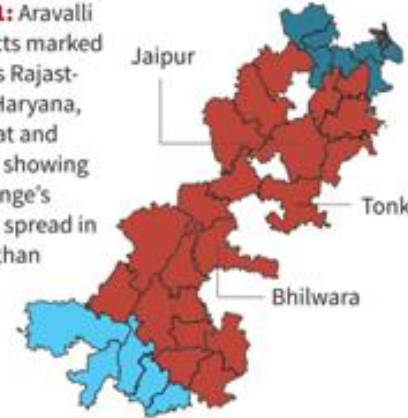
Year-on-year growth in top 10 export commodities of India Values (in \$ billion)



Source: Ministry of Commerce

Out of around 800 km, 560 km of Aravalli mountains are in Rajasthan alone!

MAP 1: Aravalli districts marked across Rajasthan, Haryana, Gujarat and Delhi, showing the range's larger spread in Rajasthan



Of the roughly 800-km-long Aravalli range spanning Gujarat, Rajasthan, Haryana and Delhi, around 560 km lie within Rajasthan. The range passes through 37 districts of which 20 are in Rajasthan. Moreover, Rajasthan alone hosts 16 of the 22 wildlife sanctuaries located in the Aravalli landscape

The US assets deployed in Operation Epic Fury

● **Operation Epic Fury: The US Assets Deployed**



AIR

- B-1 Bombers
- B-2 Stealth Bombers
- B-52 Bombers
- F-18 Fighter Jets
- F-22 Stealth Fighters
- F-35 Stealth Fighters
- F-16 Fighter Jets
- A-10 Attack Jets
- F-15 Fighter Jets
- EA-18G Electronic Warfare Aircraft
- EC-130H Electronic Warfare Aircraft
- U-2 Reconnaissance Aircraft
- RC-135 Reconnaissance Aircraft
- E-11A Communications Aircraft
- EA-37B Electronic Warfare Aircraft
- C-17 Globemaster Cargo Aircraft
- C-130J Cargo Aircraft
- KC-135 Refueling Aircraft
- KC-46 Refueling Aircraft
- KC-130 Hercules Tankers
- AH-64 Apache Helicopters
- MH-60 Sea Hawk Helicopters
- V-22 Osprey Tilt-Rotor Aircraft
- E-2D Airborne Early Warning & Control Aircraft
- MQ-9 Surveillance & Attack Drones
- LUCAS One-Way-Attack Drones

LAND

- Patriot Interceptor Missile Systems
- THAAD Anti-Ballistic Missile Systems
- M-142 High Mobility Artillery Rocket Systems
- Counter-Drone Systems



SEA

- Nuclear-Powered Aircraft Carriers
- Nuclear-Powered Submarines
- Guided-Missile Destroyers
- Refueling and Supply Ships
- Amphibious Assault Ship
- Amphibious Transport Dock Ship

TYPES OF TARGETS

- Command and Control Centers
- IRGC Headquarters Buildings
- IRGC Intelligence Sites
- Integrated Air Defence Systems
- Ballistic Missile Sites
- Iranian Navy Ships & Submarines
- Iranian Air Defence Systems
- Anti-ship Missile Sites
- Military Communication Capabilities
- Ballistic Missile & Drone Manufacturing
- Weapons Production & Storage Bunkers
- Surface-to-Air Missile Facilities
- Military Support Infrastructure

SOURCE: @CENTCOM/X

UAE hosts the highest number of Indians in Gulf region

Indians in Gulf countries

Country	No. of Workers
United Arab Emirates	43,26,248
Saudi Arabia	27,47,551
Kuwait	10,36,389
Qatar	8,30,491
Oman	6,76,781
Bahrain	3,17,564

Source - Ministry of External Affairs

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